

Ardit Koka

Varese, Italy | akoka@uninsubria.it | [Academic Website](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

Research Interests

Macroeconomics; Monetary Economics; Banking and Financial Intermediation; Monetary Policy; Financial Stability; Financial Economics; Econometrics.

Academic Appointments and Teaching

Lecturer in Statistics Oct. 2024–Present
Università degli Studi di Milano *Milan, Italy*

- Teach Statistics in Italian to more than 300 second-year B.Sc. students, covering probability, estimation, statistical inference, hypothesis testing and regression.
- Design and deliver applied exercises, support exam preparation and assessment, and translate quantitative concepts into clear problem-solving methods for students with different levels of preparation.

Honorary Fellow Mar. 2024–Present
Università degli Studi dell'Insubria *Varese, Italy*

Teaching and examination activities in five courses: *Macroeconomics*; *Monetary and Credit Economics* (M.Sc.); *Statistics*; *Mathematics*; and *Mathematics for Economics and Finance*.

Academic Tutor Feb. 2024–Present
Università degli Studi dell'Insubria *Varese, Italy*

University tutoring across Economics, Quantitative Methods, Management and related business subjects, supporting undergraduate and graduate students with coursework, problem solving and exam preparation.

Visiting PhD Researcher Sep. 2025–May 2026
Lancaster University Management School, Department of Economics *Lancaster, United Kingdom*

Conducted research on monetary-policy transmission, banking frictions and central bank digital currencies; participated in seminars, workshops and research discussions with faculty and researchers.

Education

PhD in Methods and Models for Economic Decisions Nov. 2023–Oct. 2026 (expected)
Università degli Studi dell'Insubria *Varese, Italy*

Research fields: macroeconomics, monetary economics, banking and financial intermediation, and quantitative macroeconomics.

M.Sc. in International Economics and Commerce Aug. 2020–Oct. 2022
Università Politecnica delle Marche *Ancona, Italy*

Final grade: 110/110 cum laude. Thesis: *From Cryptocurrencies to Central Bank Digital Currencies: The Case of a Digital Euro*.

B.Sc. in Applied Economics Sep. 2017–Jul. 2020
Agricultural University of Tirana *Tirana, Albania*

Research in Progress

Central Bank Digital Currency and Bank Intermediation: Mechanisms, Policy Responses, and Open Questions

Reviews the macroeconomic literature on retail CBDC through bank intermediation, monetary-policy transmission and financial stability. A central conclusion is that CBDC-induced disintermediation is not mechanical: its magnitude depends on CBDC design, substitution with deposits, banks' funding structure and the policy response. The review identifies bank liquidity, prudential regulation and central-bank refinancing as key mechanisms that remain insufficiently integrated in much of the existing literature.

When Funding Neutrality Fails: CBDC, Refinancing, and Prudential Liquidity

Studies whether central-bank refinancing can neutralise the bank-credit effects of deposit displacement caused by a capped, non-remunerated retail CBDC. In a nonlinear New Keynesian model, one-for-one refinancing restores funding quantity exactly but does not generally preserve bank credit because deposits and refinancing provide different prudential-liquidity services. The credit-minimising refinancing ratio can lie above, at, or below one. One-for-one refinancing is nearly credit-neutral under short-lived stress when refinancing provides sufficient prudential liquidity, but remains materially non-neutral when liquidity stress persists. Credit stabilisation and welfare can also favour different refinancing intensities.

Digital Flight-to-Liquidity: CBDC, Crypto Bubbles, and Bank Intermediation

Extends the banking and refinancing framework by introducing a speculative crypto asset with endogenous bubble dynamics alongside cash, deposits and CBDC. The model creates two distinct portfolio reallocation margins: substitution from bank deposits into CBDC and movements between speculative crypto assets and safer liquid assets. This makes it possible to study how crypto-market stress interacts with bank funding, liquidity and credit, and whether CBDC can serve as a digital flight-to-liquidity asset while simultaneously increasing pressure on bank intermediation.

Selected Conferences, Seminars and Presentations

Research Presentation – SoFiE Training School

National Bank of Belgium

May 2026

Brussels, Belgium

Presented and discussed *CBDC and Monetary Policy Transmission: A Two-Tier Design with Bank Intermediation Frictions*.

Research Seminar

Lancaster University Management School

Oct. 2025

Lancaster, United Kingdom

Presented *Central Bank Digital Currency, Bank Intermediation and Monetary Policy Transmission*.

Internal Seminar Series

Università degli Studi dell'Insubria

Jun. 2025

Varese, Italy

Presented *Multi-Currency DSGE Model: Interactions between Fiat, CBDC and Cryptocurrency under Banking and Bubble Constraints*.

Summer Schools and Advanced Training

SoFiE Training School – Bayesian Structural Macroeconometrics: From DSGE to HANK Estimation, Policy Analysis, and Forecasting

National Bank of Belgium

May 2026

Brussels, Belgium

Instructors: **Marco Del Negro** (Federal Reserve Bank of New York) and **Frank Schorfheide** (University of Pennsylvania). Training in Bayesian structural macroeconometrics, DSGE/HANK estimation, forecasting and policy analysis.

4th Hands-On AB-SFC Summer School

Università Politecnica delle Marche

Sep. 2025

Ancona, Italy

Agent-based and AB-SFC macroeconomic modelling, computational implementation, inequality and monetary-policy applications.

Tools for Macroeconomists – The Essentials / Advanced Tools

Graduate Summer School

Aug. 2024 / Aug. 2025

Online

Instructors: Petr Sedláček and Pontus Rendahl. DSGE solution and estimation, forecasting, Bayesian/nonlinear methods and heterogeneous-agent models.

Summer School in DSGE Macro-Modelling

University of Surrey, Centre for International Macroeconomic Studies

Sep. 2024

United Kingdom

RBC and New Keynesian models, Bayesian estimation, forecasting and policy analysis.

Academic Service

Elected Representative, Department Council

Università degli Studi dell'Insubria

Current
Varese, Italy

Participate in departmental governance, institutional decision-making and quality-assurance activities.

Elected PhD Representative, PhD Board

Università degli Studi dell'Insubria

Mandate completed Jul. 2026
Varese, Italy

Represented doctoral researchers in programme governance and contributed to quality-assurance activities and preparation for external programme review.

Awards and Scholarships

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- **PhD Scholarship**, Università degli Studi dell'Insubria, 2023–2026.
 - **Winner, Innovation Camp for PhD Students – NODES Spoke 3**, Università degli Studi dell'Insubria, 2024. Developed and presented an innovative project in a multidisciplinary team.
 - **CampusWorld Programme**, Università Politecnica delle Marche. Competitive mobility award supporting an international traineeship experience.
 - **Erasmus+ Traineeship**, European mobility scholarship for professional training abroad.
 - **Erasmus+ Study Mobility**, European scholarship supporting an international study period.
 - **ERDIS Grant**, competitive regional scholarship supporting university study.

Previous Professional Experience

Key Account Manager / Operations Lead

Back Office Solution Group

Jan. 2023–Oct. 2023

Tirana, Albania

Managed a major US corporate account and scaled the Albania-based delivery team, coordinating operations directly with senior client stakeholders.

Auditor

Deloitte

Sep. 2022–Dec. 2022

Tirana, Albania

Supported audit engagements for more than 25 Italian businesses through reconciliations, variance analysis and evidence review.

Team Leader / Sales Manager

CCS

Mar. 2019–May 2021

Tirana, Albania

Led a commercial operation of more than 70 employees, overseeing performance, recruitment and training.

Campaign Director / Sales Manager

I Project / ITK

Feb. 2018–Apr. 2019

Tirana, Albania

Directed a sales campaign of more than 60 employees, with responsibility for staffing, targets and execution.

Sales Team Leader

Italiana Holding

May 2015–Feb. 2018

Tirana, Albania

Managed sales teams, monitored performance and coached staff in an Italian-language environment.

Technical Skills

Methods: DSGE and macro-financial modelling; econometrics; statistical analysis; forecasting; scenario and sensitivity analysis; Bayesian methods.

Software: MATLAB/Dynare; Stata; R; EViews; SPSS; Gretl; L^AT_EX / Overleaf.

Languages

Albanian (Native) · Italian (Fluent) · English (Fluent) · Spanish (Intermediate)